Additional Power BI Resources

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A curated collection of tools, guides, design assets, and video tutorials to enhance your Power BI development workflow.

1. Data Modeling

Microsoft Learn — Star Schema

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/guidance/star-schema

The official Microsoft guide to star schema design for Power BI. Learn how to structure your data model using fact tables and dimension tables to maximize DAX performance, simplify report authoring, and ensure your data is optimized for Power BI's in-memory engine. Essential reading for anyone building scalable data models.

2. Power Query

Microsoft Learn — Power Query UI

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-query/power-query-ui

A comprehensive guide to the Power Query interface in Power BI. Learn how to connect to data sources, clean and transform raw data, apply M language steps, and shape datasets before they load into your model. Power Query is the foundation of a clean, maintainable ETL process inside Power BI Desktop.

3. Advanced Development

TMDL (Tabular Model Definition Language)

Microsoft Learn — TMDL View in Power BI Desktop

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/transform-model/desktop-tmdl-view

The official Microsoft guide to using the TMDL View in Power BI Desktop. TMDL (Tabular Model Definition Language) is a human-readable, text-based format for viewing and editing your semantic model's metadata directly in a code editor — without relying on the graphical Model View. This guide covers how to script tables, measures, columns, and relationships, use find-and-replace for bulk edits, access model properties not exposed in the UI, and share reusable TMDL scripts across your team. Essential for any developer looking to work more efficiently with large or complex semantic models.

🔗 **Microsoft Power BI Blog — Deep Dive into TMDL View for Power BI Desktop (Preview)**

https://powerbi.microsoft.com/en-us/blog/deep-dive-into-tmdl-view-for-power-bi-desktop-preview/

An in-depth blog post from the official Power BI team covering the TMDL View feature in Power BI Desktop. Goes beyond the documentation to demonstrate real-world workflows including scripting semantic model objects, using the code editor's search-and-replace for bulk edits, sharing reusable TMDL scripts across teams, and editing model properties not available in the graphical interface. Also covers what's coming next for TMDL view including Copilot integration and diff view. By Rui Romano, Principal Program Manager at Microsoft.

DAX User-Defined Functions (UDFs)

🔗 **Microsoft Learn — Using DAX User-Defined Functions (Preview)**

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/transform-model/desktop-user-defined-functions-overview

The official Microsoft guide to DAX User-Defined Functions (UDFs), a preview feature introduced in the September 2025 Power BI update. UDFs let you package and centralize reusable DAX logic into named functions — similar to functions in traditional programming languages — and call them from measures, calculated columns, visual calculations, and even other UDFs. This guide explains how to enable the feature, define functions using the FUNCTION keyword in DAX Query View or TMDL View, pass scalar and table parameters, and use functions across your semantic model to eliminate redundant DAX code and improve maintainability.

🔗 **Microsoft Learn — DAX User-Defined Functions Best Practices**

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/dax/best-practices/dax-user-defined-functions

Microsoft's best practices guide for writing and structuring DAX User-Defined Functions effectively. Covers how to define parameters (scalar, table, and object references), use type hints for safer authoring, nest UDFs within each other, and inspect functions via Dynamic Management Views (DMVs) and the INFO.FUNCTIONS DAX function. This is the companion reference to the overview guide and is ideal for developers who want to write clean, performant, and well-structured UDFs that scale across enterprise semantic models.

🔗 **SQLBI — Introducing User-Defined Functions in DAX**

https://www.sqlbi.com/articles/introducing-user-defined-functions-in-dax/

An in-depth technical article from SQLBI — one of the most trusted Power BI and DAX education resources — covering everything you need to know before building DAX UDFs. Goes beyond the Microsoft docs to explain the two parameter-passing modes (VAL and EXPR), how evaluation context affects function behavior, when to use CALCULATE inside a function body, and naming conventions (Pascal case) to distinguish UDFs from native DAX functions. Also introduces the free open-source DAX function library at daxlib.org, where you can find and import pre-built, community-validated UDFs directly into your semantic models.

4. Design Resources

Icons

🔗 **Iconify**

https://icon-sets.iconify.design/

A massive open-source icon library aggregating over 200,000 icons across 100+ icon sets in one place. Use Iconify to search, preview, and export icons as SVG or PNG for use in Power BI report backgrounds, button images, and custom visuals. Its unified search makes it easy to find icons that match your report's style.

🔗 **Ionic Icons (Ionicons)**

https://ionic.io/ionicons

A clean, modern icon set with over 1,300 open-source icons in sharp, outline, and filled styles. Ionicons are especially well-suited for Power BI dashboards that require a sleek, app-like aesthetic. Download icons as SVG files and embed them in report backgrounds or use them as image measures.

🔗 **Pictogrammers**

https://pictogrammers.com/

Home of the popular Material Design Icons (MDI) library, offering thousands of community-designed icons in a consistent, clean style. Pictogrammers is ideal for Power BI developers who want icons that follow Google's Material Design guidelines — perfect for corporate or technical dashboards. All icons are free and available as SVG.

Utilities

🔗 **Base64 Image Converter**

https://www.base64-image.de/

A free online tool that converts image files (PNG, JPG, SVG, etc.) into Base64-encoded strings. In Power BI, Base64 encoding is used to embed images directly into DAX measures or as URL fields in tables, enabling dynamic image rendering in visuals without relying on external URLs. This is especially useful for embedding logos, icons, or product images inside your data model.

🔗 **Dribbble — Discover the World's Top Designers & Creative Professionals**

https://dribbble.com/

A premier design inspiration platform showcasing work from top designers and creative professionals worldwide. Dribbble is an excellent resource for Power BI report design

inspiration — browse dashboard layouts, color schemes, data visualization styles, and UI patterns created by world-class designers. Use it to spark ideas for your report themes, background designs, and overall visual presentation before building in Power BI.

🔗 **Laws of UX**

https://lawsofux.com/

A beautifully designed reference site collecting the key psychological principles and best practices that govern how users perceive and interact with interfaces. Created by product designer Jon Yablonski, Laws of UX covers principles like Fitts's Law (target size and placement), Hick's Law (reducing decision fatigue), the Aesthetic-Usability Effect (attractive designs are perceived as more functional), and many more. Applying these principles to Power BI report design helps you build dashboards that feel intuitive, reduce cognitive load for your users, and guide attention to the most important information naturally.

🔗 **SQLBI — Introducing the 3-30-300 Rule for Better Reports**

https://www.sqlbi.com/articles/introducing-the-3-30-300-rule-for-better-reports/

A practical Power BI report design framework from SQLBI that structures your layouts around how long users need to extract value: in 3 seconds users should get a high-level overview of the most important KPIs; in 30 seconds they should be able to filter and zoom into specific periods or categories; and in 300 seconds (5 minutes) they should be able to drill into details to inform decisions and actions. This rule is derived from Ben Shneiderman's visual information-seeking mantra and is one of the most actionable frameworks for designing Power BI reports that are genuinely useful rather than just visually impressive.

Colors

🔗 **Coolors**

https://coolors.co/

A fast and intuitive color palette generator that helps you create harmonious color schemes in seconds. Use Coolors to define your Power BI report's theme palette — lock colors you like, generate complementary shades, and export the HEX codes directly into Power BI's JSON theme file. Especially helpful for matching brand colors or creating accessible, contrast-safe designs.

🔗 **Color Hunt**

https://colorhunt.co/

A curated, community-driven collection of color palettes organized by mood, season, and popularity. Color Hunt is a great starting point when you need design inspiration for a Power BI report theme. Browse trending palettes, copy HEX values with one click, and build a cohesive visual identity across all your report pages.

5. How To's

KPIs

🔗 **NEXT LEVEL KPI CARD using NO CUSTOM VISUALS // Power BI Tips and Tricks in 2023**

https://youtu.be/UOnkB1ExYp0?si=CsIRB04t-XNuw-OJ

A step-by-step tutorial on building advanced, fully customisable KPI card visuals in Power BI without any external or custom visuals. Covers formatting, titles, subtitles, budget comparisons, dynamic comparison switching, and conditional colours. By Fernan | Solutions Abroad.

🔗 **Use REFERENCE LABELS to add INSIGHTS to your KPI CARDS in Power BI // Feature Walkthrough**

https://youtu.be/s1MPRl6ha7o?si=05HkmKKt59f8n53I

A walkthrough of Power BI's reference label feature for card visuals, showing how to surface additional context and insights directly on your KPI cards. Covers month-on-month percentage change, formatting options, conditional colouring, and stacking multiple reference labels. By Fernan | Solutions Abroad.

🔗 **How to Create a KPI Visual in Power BI | MoM % Change Step-by-Step Tutorial**

https://youtu.be/ebwfbu-RBvU?si=stAkYHBzO1EWSrq3

A concise step-by-step tutorial on building a professional KPI visual in Power BI with Month-over-Month percentage change. Covers creating the KPI card visual, writing a DAX measure for MoM % change, displaying the change inside the card, and designing a clean, client-ready layout. By BI Tricks.

Page/Bookmark Navigation

🔗 **The ULTIMATE Page Navigation (Part 1) CLEAN MENU + ICONS | Power BI DESIGN**

https://youtu.be/-GCV4LvPMW0?si=J0N1Vyc7sSUOsp3g

Part 1 of a two-part series on building professional page navigation in Power BI. Covers setting up the built-in page navigator, creating a clean icon-based menu, designing alternative layouts, and building a horizontal menu — all with minimal maintenance required. By How to Power BI.

🔗 **The ULTIMATE Page Navigation (Part 2) ONE TRICK ENDLESS POSSIBILITIES | Power BI DESIGN**

https://youtu.be/PPBPX30fW3E?si=zfEjE8n0ZXqRYwhx

Part 2 of the Ultimate Page Navigation series, introducing a single technique that unlocks self-maintaining menus and cool visual effects. Covers using shapes alongside the built-in page navigator, stacking two page navigations for advanced effects, and step-by-step menu animation examples. By How to Power BI.

[Power BI Page Navigation Made Easy | Navigation Buttons Tutorial]

https://youtu.be/eZCA-ceHkjc?si=TTa_thvggraWlLri

A concise tutorial on building sleek, interactive page navigation in Power BI using buttons, bookmarks, and design techniques. Covers creating a modern navigation bar, configuring page navigation buttons, and improving user experience to make reports feel like polished, professional apps. By BI Tricks.

Filters

[Build a Slicer Panel in Power BI Like a PRO]

https://youtu.be/-VXZh-vDmP0?si=MUf1_X_MahLOldZ0

Part 1 of a 4-part series on building a custom filter panel in Power BI. Covers constructing a collapsible slicer panel that can be shown or hidden with a button click, saving screen space while improving dashboard user experience. Includes setting up the filter pane, adding buttons, and configuring bookmarks. By Your Own KPI.

[Build a Slicer Panel in Power BI Like a PRO - Part 2]

https://youtu.be/G3GyllXAt14?si=KkffwmCKVmIlPedN

Part 2 of the slicer panel series, adding a dynamic filter counter button that displays the number of currently active filters. Also covers building a tooltip that shows which specific filters are active, giving users instant visibility into their current selections. By Your Own KPI.

[Top 5 Ways to Show ACTIVE FILTERS in Power BI]

https://youtu.be/Nehyym4hPc8?si=ZvLG1W5rBtR6EqqN

A practical walkthrough of five different techniques for surfacing active filter selections in Power BI reports. Helps users understand exactly what filters are applied at any given time, improving transparency and usability across dashboards.